Race and the Priesthood

The Belief Files

Case File 012

Historical investigation and biblical assessment

Beyond the Message | Prepared for Jamie Dennis | November 8, 2026

Investigation summary

For much of its history, the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints restricted priesthood ordination for men of Black African descent and temple endowment and sealing for Black women and men. In 1978, those racial restrictions were removed. This investigation asks how the restrictions developed, how leaders justified them, what they meant for affected believers, and how the change should be evaluated. [2,12]

The case is about more than an old rule for who could preach. Within LDS teaching, priesthood and temple ordinances concern authority, family relationships, and eternal blessings. Baptism and membership were not identical to access to every ordinance. A historical account that mentions ordination but omits women and temple access leaves out a substantial part of the issue.

The evidence includes an early Black elder's license, Brigham Young's recorded legislative speech, Jane Manning James's petition, later leadership statements, the 1978 declaration, and subsequent teaching. These documents establish changes in policy and explanation. They do not independently establish the divine origin claimed for the restrictions or for their removal.

This case also gives weight to the people affected. Their faith, persistence, criticism, and joy should not disappear behind a debate conducted entirely about them by others. The Christian assessment concerns claims and conduct; it assigns no inherited personal guilt to today's LDS members.

The claim under investigation

The present official essay acknowledges the restrictions, early Black ordinations, and Brigham Young's public announcement in 1852. It disavows explanations involving racial inferiority, a curse expressed in Black skin, premortal unfaithfulness, or interracial marriage as sin, and condemns racism. Those present statements must be distinguished from what earlier leaders actually taught. [2]

Official Declaration 2 identifies the 1978 change as revelation to Spencer W. Kimball, affirmed by other leaders. The letter extends ordination without regard to race or color to men meeting the Church's standards, with temple blessings for members and their families. It describes prayer and the long-awaited fulfillment of promises. [12]

The questions are therefore historical and theological. Was the restriction present uniformly from the beginning? Were its explanations merely private speculation? What happened to faithful people who requested full participation? And how can a Christian distinguish divine guidance from a religious institution revising an inherited racial teaching?

How this investigation weighs evidence

A contemporary license is evidence of an ordination's recognition. A recorded speech is evidence of the teaching attributed to its speaker, subject to the record's transmission. A later institutional statement can establish what leaders asserted at that date without proving their account of earlier origins.

The distinction between the origin of a rule and the origin of an explanation is especially important. Uncertainty about the first does not erase records of the second. A theory can be disavowed today and still have been taught authoritatively by senior leaders in the past.

Terms also require care. Black African descent was the relevant ancestry classification; the policy should not be described as applying uniformly to every person now called nonwhite. Nor should a racial priesthood restriction

be treated as though it were simply the same question as every religious tradition's requirements for ministry.

This case reads selected records and published transcriptions. It does not claim a complete audit of every ordination, ancestry decision, missionary encounter, or temple application. Its source register identifies transmitted documents as transmitted documents rather than implying that every original manuscript was examined.

The historical timeline

Date	Evidence or development	What needs distinguishing
1836	Elijah Able receives an elder's license; he is also ordained a seventy that year.	A recognized early Black priesthood holder from later assertions of an unchanged founding rule. [3–4]
February 5, 1852	Young addresses the territorial legislature on slavery and priesthood.	His recorded claims from an independently verified command of God. [5]
1879	Able is denied the temple endowment.	Continuing recognition of priesthood from access to later temple ordinances. [2,4]
December 27, 1884	Jane Manning James petitions John Taylor about endowment and adoption sealing.	Her own request and reasoning from later summaries of her wishes. [6]
1894	James receives a proxy servant sealing, not the requested daughter relationship; Woodruff again refuses her endowment.	An unusual substitute ordinance from equal temple access. [7–8]
1949 and 1969	First Presidency statements defend the restriction using divine authority.	Documented leadership positions from a claim that all explanations were merely lay rumors. [9–11]

Date	Evidence or development	What needs distinguishing
June 1, 8, and 9, 1978	The reported revelatory meeting occurs June 1; the letter is dated June 8 and released through media June 9.	Meeting, letter date, and public release. [12–13]
September 30, 1978	General conference sustains the revelation.	Its formal acceptance from the earlier announcement. [12]
Later teaching	The Church disavows racial explanations and condemns racism.	Rejection of explanations from a complete historical explanation of the restriction. [2]

Exhibit one An early elder and a later restriction

Elijah Able's recognized priesthood

The Joseph Smith Papers preserves a copy of Able's March 31, 1836 elder's license in Kirtland Elders' Certificates. It recommends him as a member in good standing and authorizes his preaching. The document is a contemporary certificate-book copy, not a newly discovered original signed sheet. [3]

The biographical record identifies his elder ordination earlier that year and his December ordination as a seventy. His history therefore prevents a simple account in which Black men were never recognized as priesthood holders during Joseph Smith's lifetime. [4]

The qualification matters in both directions. An early Black elder does not show that every founding leader held modern views of racial equality. It does establish that later blanket historical claims must be checked against actual examples. One should not answer a documentary counterexample merely by repeating that a rule had always existed.

Able's later exclusion from the endowment also shows why priesthood recognition and temple access cannot be collapsed. A person could continue

to be understood as holding priesthood while still being denied an ordinance available to other members. [2,4]

Young's February 1852 speech

Young's February 5 address survives in George D. Watt's shorthand record, transcribed by LaJean Purcell Carruth. The transcription contains uncertainties and editorial indications; it should not be treated as an audio recording. It nevertheless clearly records an argument connecting African ancestry, Cain, restricted priesthood authority, and a future removal of the restriction. [5]

The occasion was a territorial legislative discussion involving slavery, not simply a later private remark taken from an unrelated conversation. Young spoke as governor and religious leader. His claims about ancestry and divine order belong within that political and religious setting.

The investigator must distinguish what the speech establishes from what it asserts. It establishes that Young taught a racial priesthood restriction with a religious explanation. It does not establish the genealogy he claimed or demonstrate that God authorized the exclusion.

Historical racial prejudice helps explain why such an argument was intelligible to its audience. It does not make the argument biblically sound. Context can explain the presence of an idea while leaving its truth and moral justification open to direct examination.

Exhibit two Jane Manning James's request

Her own theological argument

In her December 27, 1884 letter to John Taylor, James asks about her future salvation and access to blessings. She recognizes that her race and color stood in the way of an endowment, appeals to God's promise to bless the nations through Abraham, and asks to be adopted to Joseph Smith as a child. [6]

This is not merely a complaint about administrative inconvenience. James argues from the religious promises she believed. Her question exposes the distance between universal blessing and her actual access to ordinances.

Her letter also recalls an earlier offer from Emma Smith. That portion is retrospective testimony, recorded decades after the Nauvoo period. It should not be presented as a contemporary transcript of Emma's exact words. The letter is strongest as direct evidence of James's 1884 request, understanding, and persistence.

Reading James only as a silent sufferer would obscure her initiative. Reading her continued faith as proof that exclusion caused no harm would obscure the content of her request. A believer can remain loyal while asking leaders to correct or reconsider an exclusion.

The substitute did not grant the requested relationship

The Church's historical biography records repeated petitions, permission for proxy baptisms, and the unusual 1894 sealing of James by proxy into the Smith household as a servant. She did not receive her own endowment or the requested family sealing during her lifetime. The biography records later proxy completion of ordinances in 1979. [7]

These details should be stated plainly without inventing a uniform policy for all Black members from one exceptional ceremony. A servant relationship was different from adoption as a daughter. The use of proxies also means the ceremony should not be narrated as though James herself entered the temple and received equal participation that day.

Woodruff's October 16, 1894 journal records another request by James for the endowment and his refusal. He associated that refusal with the law of God and an explanation involving Cain and Abel. The entry shows a senior leader using a religious racial rationale in deciding a specific person's petition. [8]

Later proxy ordinances matter to the Church's account of her religious standing. They do not change what James was denied during her own life.

Both facts belong in the history, and neither should be used to make the other disappear.

Exhibit three The authority of the explanations

The 1949 statement

A First Presidency statement dated August 17, 1949 survives here through a typescript in the Lester Bush papers and its published transcription. It explicitly characterizes the restriction as a divine command rather than merely a declared policy, invokes earlier presidents, and discusses premortal conditions in defending it. The transmission is identified because this investigation did not examine an original signed circular. [9]

The statement matters because of the authority claimed. Its explanation cannot fairly be described as no more than an anonymous theory invented by ordinary members. Whether its reasoning was accepted by every leader or member is a different question; the text is evidence of a First Presidency position as transmitted in that record.

Its claim about continuity from the Church's beginnings also needs testing. Able's license and the historical evidence of early ordinations show why an assertion of unchanged origins is not enough. A later authoritative statement can be authoritative in an institution without being historically accurate about every earlier event. [3,9]

The 1969 letter

The December 15, 1969 letter distinguishes civil equality from the Church's religious restrictions. It affirms constitutional rights while maintaining that priesthood allocation is a religious question, appeals to continuing revelation, and attributes the restriction to God's plan. It also repeats a claim of continuity reaching back to Joseph Smith. [10]

That is a more substantial historical record than the idea that leaders simply did not know what members were saying. A defense based on divine authority was being communicated by leadership shortly before the eventual change.

The University of Virginia's published McKay diary excerpts provide context for preparation and circulation. They identify the December letter as signed by counselors Hugh B. Brown and N. Eldon Tanner. This case therefore does not invent a signature by McKay or portray the excerpt as a complete diary written personally by him in every line. [11]

The civil-rights distinction is relevant to what the letter argued. It does not settle the theological question. A religious institution can possess freedom to make a decision while the decision remains subject to biblical and moral examination.

Today's disavowal and the earlier record

The present Church's rejection of racial explanations is consequential. It should be acknowledged as a present position rather than ignored in order to make the Church appear to teach the same explanations unchanged. [2]

That rejection does not erase their earlier institutional use. Nor is disavowing an explanation automatically the same as explicitly declaring the restriction itself a human error and issuing an apology for it. Those are distinct statements; this case does not attribute a formal apology that the cited essay does not provide.

The remaining question is how members should evaluate a teaching that was defended through senior religious authority and later repudiated in its explanations. Naming the earlier material a policy instead of doctrine does not, by itself, answer what authority people were told it possessed at the time.

Exhibit four The 1978 change

Separate the dates and the content

Official Declaration 2 identifies the reported revelation with a June 1, 1978 meeting. The First Presidency letter is dated June 8. The Church's student manual distinguishes that date from the media release on June 9; general conference acceptance followed on September 30. These are stages of the event, not interchangeable announcement dates. [12–13]

The letter removes race and color as barriers to male ordination while retaining the Church's other standards. It also extends temple blessings to the affected members and their families. This was not a declaration ordaining women to LDS priesthood or abolishing every qualification for ordination. [12]

The account's language of prayer and revelation is evidence of the leaders' explanation and conviction. It should neither be silently converted into a verified divine communication nor dismissed as conscious deception without evidence of that intention.

A participant's retrospective correction

Bruce R. McConkie's August 18, 1978 address tells listeners to set aside earlier statements, including his own, that conflict with the new revelation. He describes the earlier understanding as limited and emphasizes accepting a living prophet. That is important evidence of a senior leader revising what he had previously taught. [14]

The whole relevant discussion should be read. The address also speculates about premortal devotion when explaining historical differences in access. It therefore should not be simplified into a claim that every racial explanation had been fully rejected in the same terms as the later essay. The stages of interpretation matter.

The investigator can acknowledge the correction and still ask what made the new understanding more reliable than the former one. An instruction to follow the current prophet states a rule of institutional allegiance; it does not independently establish the truth of each successive explanation.

Listening after a change

Darius Gray's 2018 article, written as a founding member and former president of Genesis, addresses the continuing wounds of racism. He urges recognition of the problem, examination of personal attitudes, and careful listening to people whose experiences differ from one's own. His voice shows that celebrating a change and addressing continuing harm are compatible tasks. [15]

Gray is not being used as a representative of every Black member or as an implied endorsement of this case file's evangelical conclusions. He speaks from his own LDS commitment. Listening responsibly includes allowing that difference to remain visible.

The institutional change was substantial. It did not make the experiences of those who lived under the restriction irrelevant, nor guarantee that racial prejudice vanished from every interaction. The historical record and the work of reconciliation address related but different questions.

Assessing the principal accounts

Witness group	What the evidence supports	What it does not establish
Able's license and biography	Early recognized Black priesthood and a later access problem. [3–4]	Universal racial equality in every founding practice.
Young's recorded speech	His public racial and religious rationale in 1852. [5]	The truth of the asserted ancestry or divine authorization.
James's letter and Woodruff's diary	Her request and a president's stated reason for refusal. [6,8]	A complete record of every petition or private conversation.
The 1949 and 1969 statements	Leadership defenses presented with religious authority. [9–11]	That every member shared every explanation.
The 1978 declaration and McConkie's address	Changed access and a subsequent account of changed understanding. [12–14]	Independent verification of a divine source.
Gray's published counsel	A Black LDS leader's call to recognize harm and listen. [15]	A single response shared by all Black believers.

Reliability should be assessed for the proposition under consideration. A document can accurately record a leader's belief while that belief is mistaken. A member can describe a powerful spiritual experience without supplying an independently repeatable test of its source. Such distinctions permit respectful treatment without surrendering critical judgment.

The strongest LDS argument

The strongest faithful account affirms the universal value of God's children, acknowledges the limitations of past understanding, and treats 1978 as a revelatory extension of blessings. A believer may see God working through an imperfect institution rather than requiring that every earlier explanation was correct. The present condemnation of racism is a real part of that position. [2,12]

The Bible itself contains changes in covenant administration and the expansion of mission beyond Israel. A defender can therefore argue that different access at different times is not, by itself, a logical contradiction. The question is whether this particular ancestry restriction and its explanations have adequate divine authorization.

That argument is stronger than pretending the exclusion did not exist. Its unresolved difficulty is the earlier presentation of racial teaching as divine command. Human fallibility may explain error; it does not automatically show how a believer should distinguish the error from guidance at the moment obedience is demanded.

Competing explanations

A divinely permitted restriction ended by revelation. This fits the faithful account of 1978 and the belief in a divine timetable. It requires grounds for accepting the restriction and its ending as God's acts, not simply the fact that leaders described them in religious terms.

An inherited racial restriction maintained by sincere religious authority. Cultural assumptions could be absorbed into religious explanation and defended by people who believed them. This accounts for

authoritative but changing rationales without requiring that every leader privately disbelieved his own words.

Institutional change shaped by conscience and worldwide growth. Questions of ancestry, membership, access, and mission could make an inherited restriction increasingly difficult to sustain. These pressures are relevant research questions, but they do not independently prove either divine guidance or deliberate fraud.

A complete explanation based only on public relations. The institution had reputational interests, but that alone cannot explain every participant's prayer, conviction, persistence, or response. A case for conscious deception needs more evidence than a motive to improve public standing.

The historical record can establish teaching, exclusion, challenge, and change more securely than it can establish the private spiritual source of each decision. The theological assessment must state its standard rather than disguise its conclusion as a fact supplied by the archive.

Motives benefits and costs

Racial restriction could preserve established authority and social boundaries while imposing costs on people denied participation. Leaders defending it also risked criticism and faced sincere questions about promises they believed. Investigating those incentives does not assign one motive to everyone involved.

For James, the issue concerned the blessings of a faith she had continued to practice. Her request should not be reduced to a tool for winning a later denominational argument. The same respect applies to members who welcomed the 1978 announcement and to those who continue asking difficult historical questions.

The present Christian reader has an obligation to apply the standard consistently. One cannot use LDS racial history to imply that evangelical institutions have an innocent record. The Southern Baptist Convention's 1995 reconciliation resolution acknowledges its own history of defending slavery and racism and asks forgiveness. That is a relevant example of the

need for Christian self-examination, not a claim about the reader's denomination. [17]

A biblical assessment

Human dignity and the misuse of ancestry

Genesis 1:26-27 grounds human dignity in God's image. Genesis 4 does not identify Cain's protective mark as Black skin. Genesis 9's curse is directed at Canaan; the passage does not establish a priesthood ban for all people of African ancestry or a universal racial hierarchy. Those later conclusions require claims the biblical text itself does not provide. [18]

The Old Testament does contain ancestry-based priestly arrangements involving Levi and Aaron. A careful argument should acknowledge them rather than claim the Bible contains no lineage distinctions of any kind. The question is whether those arrangements authorize the particular Black ancestry restriction under investigation. They do not state such a rule.

LDS readers must also consider Abraham 1:26-27 alongside 2 Nephi 26:33. The former concerns Pharaoh and a lineage excluded from a priesthood claim; the latter explicitly invites all people and affirms their equality before God. The existence of a lineage passage does not establish every later mapping of ancient peoples onto modern racial classifications. This case identifies the interpretive problem rather than treating all references to ancestry as identical. [16]

Inclusion in Christ is more than proximity

Acts 10 presents the reception of Gentiles and God's rejection of partiality. Acts 8 records the Ethiopian official's reception of the gospel. These passages should be read in their own Jewish-Gentile and geographical contexts, rather than forced into a one-to-one reproduction of modern racial categories. They nevertheless challenge ancestry as a reason to withhold the gospel's promise from those received by Christ. [19]

Galatians 3:26-29 concerns belonging to Christ and being heirs of the promise. It does not erase every cultural difference or settle every

ministry-role debate. Ephesians 2:11-22 describes reconciliation and shared access to the Father through Christ. Neither supplies a Black ancestry barrier to Christian standing. [20]

This makes the difference between membership and full religious access significant. Allowing a person to attend or be baptized does not answer every question about withholding an ordinance described as eternally consequential.

A leader can require correction

Galatians 2 records Paul's confrontation of Peter over conduct inconsistent with the gospel's treatment of Gentiles. Peter's prominence does not make the conduct immune from correction. A Christian standard of authority therefore requires examination of teaching and behavior rather than assuming that a leader's office makes every application safe. [20]

Recognizing fallibility is only the beginning. A church should be able to say what was wrong, whom it harmed, and why the correction follows from God's truth. First John 1:8-9 and James 2:1-9 make confession and rejection of partiality relevant to Christian institutions as well as to the religion being studied. [22]

The gospel's assurance rests in Christ

Hebrews 10:19-22 locates access to God in Jesus' work; 1 Timothy 2:5 identifies Christ as mediator. From this series' evangelical perspective, no racial ancestry can qualify or disqualify a person for the saving sufficiency of that mediator. [21]

Ephesians 2:8-10 joins salvation by grace with the good works that follow. Christian witness should state that promise clearly while rejecting racist attitudes in the witness's own life. The purpose is to introduce Christ truthfully, not exploit someone else's injury or demand that an LDS friend disown a community before being heard. [23]

Findings and confidence

Finding	Confidence	Basis or limit
Black men held recognized priesthood in the early Church.	High	Able's contemporary certificate-book license and documented biography. [3–4]
The restrictions affected temple access for women as well as ordination for men.	High	James's request, decisions, and the later change. [6–8,12]
Senior leaders defended racial exclusion through claimed divine authority.	High	The 1852 speech, Woodruff's diary, and transmitted leadership statements. [5,8–11]
The restrictions were removed in 1978 and current racial explanations are disavowed.	High	Declaration and present essay; the two address distinct questions. [2,12]
Every present member endorses the old explanations or bears personal responsibility for them.	Not established	The record does not support inherited collective guilt.
The documents independently verify divine authorization for the restriction.	Not established	They record claims, actions, and experiences rather than an independent demonstration of their source.

Overall assessment

The evidence establishes a consequential racial restriction, early exceptions that challenge claims of uniform origins, authoritative defenses over time, persistent requests from affected believers, and a substantial change in 1978. Today's rejection of racial explanations deserves acknowledgment. It does not remove the need to examine the authority those explanations carried earlier.

The evangelical assessment is that the restriction lacks adequate biblical warrant and that its history raises a serious question about identifying reliable spiritual authority. The conclusion is directed at the claimed teaching and its basis, not at the worth or sincerity of LDS people.

This completes the twelve numbered LDS investigations. The next resource is the separate Christian conversation guide: how to listen, define shared words, discuss the evidence honestly, explain the gospel, and maintain a relationship when agreement does not follow.

Read compare and discuss

1. Why must priesthood ordination and women's temple access both appear in the investigation?
2. What does Able's license establish, and which larger claims would go beyond it?
3. Read James's 1884 petition. How does she argue from the promises of the faith she practices?
4. What is the difference between an unknown origin, a documented justification, and a justification later disavowed?
5. How should the 1949 and 1969 statements affect a claim that the explanations were only private speculation?
6. Why should the June 1 meeting, June 8 letter, June 9 media release, and September 30 acceptance remain distinct?

7. What standard would help a believer recognize when an authoritative religious explanation needs correction?
8. Read Galatians 2:11-21 and James 2:1-9. How should the same standard be applied in your own Christian community?
9. How can you ask about this history without assigning personal blame to an LDS friend or treating a Black believer as an illustration rather than a person?

Accuracy notes and further research

The supplied packet provides the starting research; the source register identifies the documents checked for this case. It does not imply a complete review of every original archive. Able's license is a contemporary copy; the 1949 statement is consulted through a transmitted typescript; the 1969 letter is a published reproduction checked against diary context. [1,3,9–11]

Keep these distinctions in app excerpts, lessons, and future book work: baptism versus full temple access; priesthood recognition versus endowment; Black African ancestry versus every nonwhite identity; a servant sealing versus adoption as a child; disavowing an explanation versus formally repudiating a restriction; a letter's date versus its public release.

Further research should expand Black members' own correspondence and oral histories, compare particular ancestry decisions, and examine original leadership files where accessible. Their voices should add substance to the history rather than serve only to confirm an outsider's preferred conclusion. Do not infer a formal institutional apology from a statement that condemns racism without making that additional statement.

Sources and reading

[1] Jamie Dennis, supplied LDS Gospel Topics Essays research compilation, Race and the Priesthood material, physical PDF pages 253-291. Starting packet; its broad claims and dates are checked against the sources below.

[2] The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, "Race and the Priesthood," Gospel Topics Essays. Present institutional account and disavowal. Its reference to June 8 is distinguished from the letter's later media release. Open source

[3] "License for Elijah Able, 31 March 1836," Joseph Smith Papers. Version copied circa April 5, 1836 in Kirtland Elders' Certificates, page 61. Open source

[4] Joseph Smith Papers, "Elijah Able," biographical record. Ordinations and later life; distinguish the license date from the elder ordination date. Open source

[5] Brigham Young, February 5, 1852 legislative address, George D. Watt papers, MS 4534, box 1, folder 3, transcribed by LaJean Purcell Carruth, March 1, 2013, Church History Library. Selected relevant passages consulted with transcription qualifications. Open source

[6] Jane E. James to John Taylor, December 27, 1884, reproduced in Henry J. Wolfinger, "A Test of Faith," Social Accommodation in Utah (1975), document 1, page 148; transcription reproduced by the B. H. Roberts Foundation. Her own request is distinguished from her retrospective recollection of Emma's offer. Open source

[7] The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, "Jane Elizabeth Manning James," Church History Topics. Petitions, proxy baptisms, the unusual 1894 servant sealing, and later proxy ordinances. Open source

[8] Wilford Woodruff, journal, October 16, 1894, MS 1352, Church History Library; transcript reproduced by the B. H. Roberts Foundation. The specific request and refusal are consulted through this reproduction. Open source

[9] First Presidency statement, August 17, 1949, typescript, Lester Bush Papers, box 10, folder 3, Marriott Special Collections; reproduced by the B. H. Roberts Foundation. This is a transmitted typescript, not an original signed circular inspected here. Open source

[10] First Presidency letter, December 15, 1969, signed by Hugh B. Brown and N. Eldon Tanner; text reproduced at FAIR, "First Presidency statements about the priesthood ban." Primary letter text, not FAIR's apologetic conclusions. Open source

[11] University of Virginia, Mormon Studies, "David O. McKay Diaries: Blacks," especially the December 25, 1969 entry discussing the December 15 letter's preparation, signatories, and circulation. Selected published excerpts, not a complete personal diary audit. Open source

[12] Official Declaration 2, Doctrine and Covenants. June 8, 1978 letter, introductory account of the June 1 meeting, and September 30 conference proceedings. Open source

[13] Doctrine and Covenants Student Manual, chapter 56, "Official Declaration 2." The section on the announcement expressly distinguishes the June 8 letter from the June 9 media release. Open source

[14] Bruce R. McConkie, "All Are Alike unto God," August 18, 1978, BYU Speeches. Read the correction of earlier statements together with the address's continuing premortal speculation. Open source

[15] Darius Gray, "Moving Forward Together," Ensign, June 2018. A Black LDS author's own counsel on recognizing racism and listening; not an endorsement of this case file. Open source

[16] Abraham 1:26-27, Pearl of Great Price; 2 Nephi 26:33, Book of Mormon. Distinguish the texts from later mappings onto modern racial identities. Open source ; Open source

[17] Southern Baptist Convention, "Resolution on Racial Reconciliation on the 150th Anniversary of the Southern Baptist Convention," June 1995. Primary institutional acknowledgment and request for forgiveness, included for consistent Christian self-examination. Open source

[18] Genesis 1:26-27; 4:1-16; 9:18-27. KJV. Human dignity, Cain's mark, and the actual subject of Noah's curse.

[19] Acts 8:26-40; 10:1-48; 17:26-27. KJV. Mission and inclusion in their historical contexts.

[20] Galatians 2:11-21; 3:26-29; Ephesians 2:11-22. KJV. Correction of a leader, belonging to Christ, and shared access.

[21] Hebrews 10:19-22; 1 Timothy 2:5. KJV. Access to God through Christ and Christ's mediation.

[22] James 2:1-9; 1 John 1:8-9; 4:1. KJV. Partiality, confession, and testing spiritual claims.

[23] Matthew 28:18-20; Ephesians 2:8-10. KJV. The Christian mission and salvation by grace with resulting good works.